Foreword

The early years of childhood are a time of wonder-when curiosity is boundless, imagination is vivid, and every experience becomes a step in the journey of learning. These textbooks for Classes 1 to 3 have been developed to honour this spirit, creating a learning experience that is joyful, meaningful, and engaging.

Developed as part of the **Tamil Nadu State Education Policy-2025**, these books mark a significant step towards strengthening foundational education in the State. The vision and direction provided by the **Hon'ble Minister for School Education** have ensured that the policy's emphasis on child-centred, competency-based, and inclusive learning is meaningfully reflected in these materials.

The leadership of the **Additional Chief Secretary,** School Education has been instrumental in ensuring the integration of 21st-century skills and knowledge, and in shaping the textbooks into engaging story-driven learning experiences.

This is further reflected in a competency-based approach to curriculum and assessment that moves beyond rote learning to foster deep conceptual understanding and meaningful application. The integration of value education to build character, along with life skills, art and motor skill development, enables the holistic development of the child.

The members of the High-Level Curriculum Expert Committee, the Chairperson and the members of the Curriculum Development Committee, have provided constant guidance, shaping and refining these materials through their insights and expertise, alongside the contributions of educators and practitioners acknowledged elsewhere in this book.

At this foundational stage, learning must build strong foundations while supporting the overall development of the child. These textbooks bring together a carefully designed set of features that make learning active, engaging, and meaningful:

- Opportunities for speaking and listening, building confidence in expression
- Activities that strengthen logical thinking and conceptual understanding
- Integrated spaces for reading and writing practice within lessons
- Fine and gross motor skill development through drawing, colouring, tracing, and movement-based tasks
- Simple avenues for independent learning and self-reflection

The books also integrate values and life skills, helping children develop empathy, cooperation, responsibility and confidence.

Learning is guided by a competency-based approach that moves beyond memorisation towards understanding and application. Assessment is embedded within the learning process, making it continuous, meaningful and supportive.

These textbooks are learning companions that invite children to explore, think and express. They represent a shared commitment to enabling every child to learn with joy, grow with confidence, and build a strong foundation for the future-advancing a vision of **"Education reimagined, inclusive, equitable, and future-ready".**

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